

Education Loan & Forex Handbook

Everything you need to know about funding your US education — loans, forex, and remittance

■ Top Education Loan Lender Comparison (2026)

Lender	Type	Max Amount	Interest Rate	Collateral	Processing Time
SBI Global Ed-Vantage	Govt Bank	USD 1.5L	10.9%	Yes	3–4 weeks
HDFC Credila	NBFC	No limit	10.5–13%	Optional	2–3 weeks
Avanse Financial	NBFC	USD 1L+	11–13%	Optional	2–3 weeks
Prodigy Finance	Fintech	USD 220K	10–15%	No	1–2 weeks
MPOWER Financing	Fintech	USD 100K	12–15%	No	1–2 weeks
Leap Finance	Fintech	INR 75L	11–14%	No	1 week
Axis Bank	Pvt Bank	USD 1L	11.5%	Yes	3–4 weeks
ICICI Bank	Pvt Bank	No limit	10.5%	Optional	3 weeks

■ Loan Application Document Checklist

Document	Required By	Notes
Valid Passport	All lenders	Must be valid for 6+ months
Admission Letter (I-20)	All lenders	Official letter from US university
Academic Transcripts	All lenders	Last 3 years mark sheets
Fee Structure from University	All lenders	Official tuition breakdown
Income Proof (Co-applicant)	Most lenders	Last 3 years ITR + salary slips
Bank Statements	Most lenders	Last 6 months (co-applicant)
KYC Documents	All lenders	Aadhaar + PAN for student & co-applicant
Collateral Documents	Secured loans	Property papers (if applicable)
GRE/SAT Score Card	Some lenders	Prodigy, MPOWER often ask

■ Forex & Remittance Guide for Students

Topic	Key Information
LRS Limit (India)	USD 250,000 per financial year per individual — covers tuition + living

TCS on Remittance	5% TCS on amounts above INR 7 lakh under LRS (claimable in ITR)
TCS for Education Loan	Reduced TCS of 0.5% if remittance is funded by an education loan
Best Platforms	Wise (TransferWise), NIYO, BookMyForex often beat bank rates by 1–2%
When to Transfer	Transfer when USD/INR rate dips — avoid end-of-month peak rates
University Wire	Always use the exact SWIFT/IBAN details from your admit letter
Multi-Currency Account	Open a Niyo Global or HDFC Forex card before travelling
Emergency Reserve	Keep 3 months of living expenses in USD in a US bank account

Disclaimer: Rates and limits are indicative as of 2026. Always verify with your lender and RBI guidelines.

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